

What are your current thoughts about Hong Kong?

The decision in Hong Kong to vote down the electoral reform package last year has caused Hong Kong residents to think seriously about the future of the territory. Perhaps this is an indication that the gap is closing between the mainland and Hong Kong despite a deadlock of political challenges.

How have recent ties been between China, Hong Kong and Taiwan?

Mounting challenges for China’s President Xi Jinping on the South China Seas and continued tension amid the economic slowdown has not deterred China from closing its political and cultural grip on both Hong Kong and Taiwan. Last March, this was confirmed at the China People’s Consultative Conference, one of the most senior political advisory bodies in the congress, and the National People’s Congress – despite the recent demands from seniors within Hong Kong for an increasing degree of economy and democracy. If applicable, this will mean China will be balancing one country, three systems if Taiwan fails to continue recognizing China’s 1992 consensus of One China. One can expect that Taiwan will drag its heels, whilst China may slow economic development and political communications with the new leadership of Taiwan. One may also presume that the mainland will tighten its grip on both Hong Kong and Taiwan this coming year.

What should we be expecting from China in the future?

China, I believe, will push forward towards closer cooperation with countries not only within ASEAN, but with the EU and almost all developing countries including Africa and America. For example, bilateral annual trade volume with the EU is expected to reach US\$1 trillion in a few years, but no later than 2020 which is a mutual goal.

Despite a slowdown this year, it seems manageable if China maintains a 6% to 7% GDP year-on-year. The same opportunities also apply in both central and eastern Europe.



The impact of the recent global financial crisis and the middle east migration of displaced refugees has created distractions but creates even more debt in the Eurozone, France, Greece, Spain and Turkey among others. These countries are being hit even more so with increasing labour strikes. Therefore Europe may delay China and the EU reaching its trade goals, particularly since the loss of labour overall has been rising in the EU for the last six years.

Another indication of China’s rapidly rising role in global leadership is the AIIB (Asian Infrastructure Bank). Already half of all EU member states are founding members. Equally impressive is the recent agreement between the IMF and AIIB to consider joint process. Additional joint investment funds will follow to compliment the One Belt, One Road initiative which, with the Chinese mega project of infrastructure development, will certainly shroud the building of The Great Wall. Despite the global economic slowdown, China will continue to forge new partnerships and explore new opportunities regionally and globally.

你對香港當前的情況有何看法？

香港立法會於2015年否決政改方案後，不少香港居民開始認真地考慮特區的未來。儘管政治僵局持續，這或許證明中港兩地之間的差距正在縮小。

中港台之間的關係最近有何發展？

國家主席習近平因南海問題及經濟增長放緩而備受壓力，卻無損中國逐步收緊對香港及台灣的政治和文化影響。2016年3月，全國政協及全國人大無視香港民主派元老要求更大的經濟及民主自主權，就確認了上述的決心。如台灣不繼續承認1992年達成的一個中國共識，意味中國將以一國三制作平衡。不難想像，台灣可能會採取不合作態度，而中國則可能放慢就台灣經濟發展及政治問題與台灣領導人對話的步伐，並進一步收緊對港台兩地的控制。

中國在未來將有何舉措？

我相信中國將與東盟、歐盟乃至非洲及南美等大多數發展中國家發展合作關係。例如，中歐的雙邊貿易額預計在未來數年間將突破1萬億美元大關；於2020年前實現這目標，是雙方的共同目標。

儘管經濟放緩，中國取得按年6%至7%的增長率，還屬控制範圍之內。中歐及東歐多國亦擁有相同的機會。

全球金融危機的後遺影響以及中東戰亂導致的難民潮，不僅對各國構成問題，更導致歐元區內法國、希臘、西班牙，甚至歐元區外的土耳其等國債務惡化。愈加頻繁的工潮，更令情況雪上加霜。因此，中歐之間要達致貿易目標，可能需要更多時間，尤其是因為歐盟在過去6年間損失了不少整體勞動力。

亞投行的成立，是中國在全球體系中領導能力提升的又一標誌。歐盟各國中有近半是亞投行的創始成員，而國際貨幣基金組織與亞投行最近達成協議考慮雙邊合作，更是令人鼓舞。隨之而來的投資基金，可支持中國最近宣布的一帶一路發展策略。中國投資的基建項目，其數目之多及規模之巨，將可媲美長城。儘管全球經濟放緩，中國將繼續建立新的合作夥伴關係，並在全球開拓新機遇。